

UNIT 1: INTRODUCTION TO WRITTEN COMMUNICATION

1.1 What is Written Communication?

Written communication is the process of conveying messages, information, or ideas through written symbols and words. It is a formal, documented, and permanent mode of communication.

Definition (2 marks): Written communication is any communication that involves the use of written words — letters, reports, emails, memos, notices — to convey information between a sender and receiver.

1.2 Importance of Written Communication

- Serves as a permanent record for future reference.
- Can be read and revised multiple times before sending.
- Suitable for complex information that requires detailed explanation.
- Legal and official validity — accepted as evidence.
- Reaches a wide audience simultaneously.
- Reduces chances of misunderstanding.

1.3 Advantages and Disadvantages of Written Communication

Advantages	Disadvantages
Permanent record maintained.	Time-consuming to prepare.
Accurate and precise.	No immediate feedback possible.
Can be referred to anytime.	Expensive if sent physically.
Suitable for complex matters.	Impersonal — lacks emotional warmth.
Wide coverage through mass communication.	Misinterpretation possible without context.

UNIT 2: GRAMMAR AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

2.1 Parts of Speech

- **Noun:** Name of a person, place, thing, or idea. (e.g., girl, India, honesty)
- **Pronoun:** Used in place of a noun. (e.g., he, she, they, it)
- **Verb:** Expresses action or state of being. (e.g., run, is, write)
- **Adjective:** Describes a noun. (e.g., tall, beautiful, red)
- **Adverb:** Describes a verb, adjective, or another adverb. (e.g., quickly, very, well)
- **Preposition:** Shows relationship between noun and other words. (e.g., in, on, at, by)
- **Conjunction:** Joins words or clauses. (e.g., and, but, or, because)
- **Interjection:** Expresses sudden emotion. (e.g., Wow!, Oh!, Alas!)

2.2 Sentence Structure

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete thought. Every sentence must have a **subject** and a **predicate**.

Types of Sentences Based on Structure:

- **Simple Sentence:** Contains one independent clause.
Example: *She reads books.*
- **Compound Sentence:** Contains two independent clauses joined by a conjunction.
Example: *She reads books, and he watches films.*
- **Complex Sentence:** Contains one independent clause and one dependent clause.
Example: *Although she was tired, she completed her assignment.*
- **Compound-Complex:** Contains two independent clauses and at least one dependent clause.

Types of Sentences Based on Meaning:

- **Declarative:** Makes a statement. (She is a student.)
- **Interrogative:** Asks a question. (Is she a student?)
- **Imperative:** Gives a command. (Please sit down.)
- **Exclamatory:** Expresses strong emotion. (What a beautiful day!)

2.3 Tenses — Complete Guide

Tense indicates the time of an action or event — past, present, or future.

Present Tense:

Type	Structure	Example
Simple Present	Subject + V1 + s/es	She writes a letter.
Present Continuous	Subject + is/am/are + V-ing	She is writing a letter.
Present Perfect	Subject + has/have + V3	She has written a letter.
Present Perfect Continuous	Subject + has/have been + V-ing	She has been writing for an hour.

Past Tense:

Type	Structure	Example
Simple Past	Subject + V2	She wrote a letter.
Past Continuous	Subject + was/were + V-ing	She was writing a letter.
Past Perfect	Subject + had + V3	She had written a letter.
Past Perfect Continuous	Subject + had been + V-ing	She had been writing for an hour.

Future Tense:

Type	Structure	Example
Simple Future	Subject + will/shall + V1	She will write a letter.
Future Continuous	Subject + will be + V-ing	She will be writing a letter.
Future Perfect	Subject + will have + V3	She will have written a letter.
Future Perfect Continuous	Subject + will have been + V-ing	She will have been writing for an hour.

UNIT 3: FORMAL AND INFORMAL WRITING

3.1 Formal Writing

Formal writing is used in professional, academic, and official contexts. It follows strict rules of grammar and tone.

Features of Formal Writing:

- Uses professional and polite language.
- Avoids slang, contractions, and colloquial expressions.
- Follows a structured format.
- Is clear, concise, and objective.
- Uses third-person where possible.

Examples:

Business letters, official emails, reports, applications, notices.

3.2 Informal Writing

Informal writing is used in personal or casual contexts. It is relaxed and friendly in tone.

Features of Informal Writing:

- Uses casual, conversational language.
- May use contractions, slang, and abbreviations.
- Flexible structure.
- Personal and emotional in tone.
- First-person perspective common.

3.3 Formal vs. Informal Writing

Basis	Formal Writing	Informal Writing
Language	Professional, polished	Casual, friendly
Tone	Objective, impersonal	Personal, emotional
Structure	Fixed and organised	Flexible
Contractions	Avoided	Commonly used
Examples	Official letters, reports	Personal letters, text messages

UNIT 4: LETTER WRITING

4.1 Parts of a Formal Letter

1. **Sender's Address**
2. **Date**
3. **Receiver's Name and Address**
4. **Subject Line**
5. **Salutation** (Dear Sir/Madam)
6. **Body of the Letter** (Introduction, Main Content, Conclusion)
7. **Complimentary Close** (Yours sincerely, Yours faithfully)
8. **Signature and Name**

4.2 Sample Formal Letter

15, Laxmi Nagar, Pune - 411001 Date: 1st May 2026

The Principal,
ABC College of Science,
Mumbai - 400001

Subject: Application for Admission

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to apply for admission to the Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) programme for the academic year 2026-27.

I have recently completed my HSC (12th) examination with 85% marks from the Maharashtra State Board. I am keen to pursue my higher education in Computer Applications and believe that your institution provides excellent facilities and faculty.

Kindly let me know the admission procedure, required documents, and last date for submission of the application form.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

(Signature)

Raj Sharma

4.3 Informal Letter Format

- Sender's address and date (at the top)
- Salutation (Dear [Name],)
- Body (casual and personal tone)
- Closing (With love, / Your friend,)
- Signature

UNIT 5: PARAGRAPH AND ESSAY WRITING

5.1 Paragraph Writing

A paragraph is a group of related sentences that discuss one main idea. Every paragraph has three parts:

- **Topic Sentence:** States the main idea of the paragraph.
- **Supporting Sentences:** Provide details, examples, or evidence.
- **Concluding Sentence:** Summarises or closes the discussion.

5.2 Essay Writing

An essay is a longer piece of writing that explores a topic in detail. It consists of:

- **Introduction:** Introduces the topic and states the thesis.
- **Body:** Three or more paragraphs that develop the main argument with evidence.
- **Conclusion:** Summarises the main points and provides a final thought.

5.3 Types of Essays

- **Descriptive Essay:** Describes a person, place, or thing in detail.
- **Narrative Essay:** Tells a story from personal experience.
- **Expository Essay:** Explains or informs about a topic.
- **Argumentative / Persuasive Essay:** Presents an argument and persuades the reader.

UNIT 6: EMAIL, REPORT, AND NOTICE WRITING

6.1 Email Writing

Parts of a Formal Email:

- **To:** Receiver's email address.
- **Cc/Bcc:** Copy to others if needed.
- **Subject:** Brief description of the email's purpose.
- **Salutation:** Dear Mr./Ms. [Name] or Dear Sir/Madam.
- **Body:** Clear and concise content.
- **Closing:** Regards, / Sincerely, followed by name and designation.

6.2 Notice Writing

A notice is a short written or printed announcement meant to inform a group of people about an event or important matter.

Format of a Notice:

- Name of the organisation/school/college
- The word "NOTICE" in capital letters
- Date
- Subject/Heading
- Body
- Name and designation of the issuing authority

6.3 Report Writing

A report is a formal document that presents information systematically about a given topic or event for a specific audience.

Structure of a Report:

- Title
- Introduction / Background
- Methodology
- Findings / Observations
- Conclusion and Recommendations

20 MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS — ENG-123

Q1. What is written communication? What are its advantages and disadvantages?

[6 marks]

Ans. Written communication is the method of conveying messages using written words, symbols, or graphics through various media such as letters, emails, reports, and notices.

Advantages:

- Permanent record: Can be stored and referenced later.
- Accuracy: Messages can be carefully composed, checked, and corrected.
- Wide reach: Can be sent to many people simultaneously.
- Legal validity: Accepted as official evidence.
- No need for immediate presence of receiver.

Disadvantages:

- Time-consuming: Drafting and editing takes time.
- No immediate feedback: Response may be delayed.
- Impersonal: Lacks tone and emotion of oral communication.
- Costly: Printing and mailing expenses for physical documents.
- Possibility of misinterpretation without contextual cues.

Q2. Explain the 12 tenses with examples.

[6 marks]

Ans. English has 12 tenses — 4 each for present, past, and future:

Tense	Example
Simple Present	She writes a letter.
Present Continuous	She is writing a letter.
Present Perfect	She has written a letter.
Present Perfect Continuous	She has been writing for two hours.
Simple Past	She wrote a letter.
Past Continuous	She was writing a letter.
Past Perfect	She had written a letter before he arrived.
Past Perfect Continuous	She had been writing for two hours.
Simple Future	She will write a letter.
Future Continuous	She will be writing a letter.
Future Perfect	She will have written the letter by noon.
Future Perfect Continuous	She will have been writing for two hours.

Q3. Write the format of a formal letter and give a sample.

[6 marks]

Ans. Format of a Formal Letter:

1. Sender's Address (top left or right)
2. Date
3. Receiver's Name and Address
4. Subject Line
5. Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam)

6. Opening Paragraph (purpose of the letter)
7. Body Paragraph (main content)
8. Closing Paragraph (call to action)
9. Complimentary Close (Yours sincerely/faithfully)
10. Signature and Full Name

Sample: Refer to the sample letter in Unit 4 above.

Q4. Differentiate between formal and informal writing.

[4 marks]

Ans.

Formal Writing	Informal Writing
Professional and polished language	Casual, conversational language
Objective and impersonal tone	Personal and friendly tone
Contractions avoided	Contractions freely used
Fixed structure	Flexible structure
Examples: Business letter, report	Examples: Personal letter, text message

Q5. What are the types of sentences? Explain with examples.

[4 marks]

Ans.

- **Simple Sentence:** Has one subject and one predicate. *She dances well.*
- **Compound Sentence:** Two independent clauses joined by a conjunction. *She dances, and he sings.*
- **Complex Sentence:** One main clause and one subordinate clause. *Although she was tired, she finished her work.*
- **Compound-Complex:** Contains two independent and one dependent clause. *She dances well, and he sings, but they never perform together.*

Q6. What are the parts of a paragraph? Explain with example.

[4 marks]

Ans. A paragraph consists of three parts:

1. **Topic Sentence:** Introduces the main idea. *"Exercise is essential for a healthy life."*
2. **Supporting Sentences:** Develop the idea with details. *"Regular physical activity strengthens muscles, improves cardiovascular health, and boosts mental well-being."*
3. **Concluding Sentence:** Wraps up the paragraph. *"Therefore, everyone should include at least 30 minutes of exercise in their daily routine."*

Q7. What is email communication? Write a sample formal email.

[6 marks]

Ans. Email communication is the electronic transfer of written messages from one person to another using internet-based mail services.

Sample Formal Email:

To: principal@abccollege.edu.in

Subject: Request for Study Leave

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am Rahul Sharma, a student of BCA First Year (Roll No. 101). I am writing to request a study leave of three days (5th to 7th May 2026) to prepare for my upcoming examinations.

I assure you that I will complete all my pending assignments before my leave commences.

Kindly grant the requested leave.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,
Rahul Sharma

Q8. Write the 8 parts of speech with examples.

[6 marks]

Ans.

Part of Speech	Definition	Example
Noun	Name of a person/place/thing/idea	Mumbai, book, courage
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	he, she, they, it
Verb	Action or state word	run, is, think
Adjective	Describes a noun	tall, red, happy
Adverb	Describes a verb/adjective/adverb	quickly, very, well
Preposition	Shows relationship	in, on, at, under
Conjunction	Joins words or clauses	and, but, because, or
Interjection	Expresses sudden emotion	Wow!, Alas!, Hurrah!

Q9. What is a notice? Write the format of a notice.

[4 marks]

Ans. A notice is a short, formal written announcement informing a group of people about an event, rule, or matter of importance.

Format:

1. Name of the institution (at top)
2. The word "NOTICE" in capitals and bold
3. Date of issue
4. Heading/Subject
5. Body of the notice (what, when, where)
6. Name and signature of issuing authority

Q10. Define 'tense' and write the uses of Simple Present Tense.

[2 marks]

Ans. Tense is the form of a verb that shows the time of an action — past, present, or future.

Uses of Simple Present Tense:

- Habitual actions: *She wakes up at 6 a.m.*
- Universal truths: *The sun rises in the east.*
- Schedule: *The train leaves at 10 a.m.*

Q11. Explain the structure of a report.

[4 marks]

Ans. A report is a formal written document presenting information about a specific topic or event.

Structure:

1. **Title Page:** Title of the report, name, date.
2. **Introduction:** Purpose and background of the report.
3. **Methodology:** How information was gathered.
4. **Findings:** Detailed observations or data.
5. **Conclusion:** Summary of findings.
6. **Recommendations:** Suggestions based on findings.

Q12. What are the features of good writing?

[4 marks]

Ans.

- **Clarity:** Writing must be clear and easy to understand.
- **Conciseness:** Avoid unnecessary words; be brief.
- **Coherence:** Ideas must flow logically from one to another.
- **Correctness:** Grammar, spelling, and punctuation must be correct.
- **Completeness:** Include all necessary information.
- **Courtesy:** Maintain a respectful and polite tone.

Q13. Write a paragraph on the importance of education.

[4 marks]

Ans. Education is the most powerful tool that shapes the future of an individual and society. It equips people with knowledge, skills, and values necessary to face life's challenges. Through education, individuals gain the ability to think critically, make informed decisions, and contribute meaningfully to their communities. Education also promotes equality by providing everyone, regardless of background, with the opportunity to succeed. In today's competitive world, a quality education opens doors to better career opportunities and financial security. Therefore, education is not just a privilege but a fundamental right that every individual should have access to.

Q14. What is a memo? Write its format.

[2 marks]

Ans. A memo (memorandum) is a short internal written communication used within an organisation to convey information or instructions.

Format: To: / From: / Date: / Subject: / Body / Signature.

Q15. Explain subject-verb agreement with examples.

[4 marks]

Ans. Subject-verb agreement means the subject and verb in a sentence must agree in number (singular or plural).

Rules:

- Singular subject → singular verb: *She writes well.*
- Plural subject → plural verb: *They write well.*
- Two subjects joined by "and" → plural verb: *Ram and Shyam are friends.*
- "Either/or", "neither/nor" → verb agrees with the nearer subject: *Either he or they are responsible.*

Q16. What are the types of essays? Explain briefly.

[4 marks]

Ans.

- **Descriptive Essay:** Describes a person, place, or object in vivid detail. *My Favourite Place*
- **Narrative Essay:** Tells a story based on personal experience. *The Best Day of My Life*
- **Expository Essay:** Explains a topic factually. *How Computers Work*
- **Argumentative Essay:** Presents an argument and persuades readers with evidence. *Should Social Media be Banned?*

Q17. What is the difference between 'yours sincerely' and 'yours faithfully'?

[2 marks]

Ans.

- **Yours sincerely:** Used when the receiver's name is known (e.g., Dear Mr. Sharma).
- **Yours faithfully:** Used when the receiver's name is not known (e.g., Dear Sir/Madam).

Q18. Explain the use of Past Perfect Tense. Give examples.

[2 marks]

Ans. Past Perfect Tense is used to describe an action that was completed before another past action.

Structure: Subject + had + V3 (past participle)

Examples:

- She had finished her homework before her mother arrived.

- The train had left before he reached the station.
- They had eaten dinner when she called.

Q19. Write an application to your principal requesting for a character certificate.

[6 marks]

Ans.

Room No. 5, Boys' Hostel,
ABC College, Pune - 411001
Date: 1st May 2026

The Principal,
ABC College of Science and Commerce,
Pune - 411001

Subject: Request for Character Certificate

Respected Sir/Madam,

I, Rahul Sharma, am a student of BCA Third Year (Roll No. 301, Batch 2023-2026). I have recently completed my final year examinations and am now applying for a job at XYZ Technology Pvt. Ltd.

As part of their application process, I am required to submit a character certificate issued by my college. I humbly request you to kindly issue the same at the earliest.

I shall be highly obliged for your kind assistance.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,
(Signature)

Rahul Sharma
BCA Third Year, Roll No. 301

Q20. What are the 7 C's of Written Communication?

[6 marks]

Ans. The 7 C's are the principles that make written communication effective:

1. **Clarity:** The message must be clearly expressed so the reader understands it without confusion.
2. **Conciseness:** Use as few words as necessary without losing meaning.
3. **Correctness:** Ensure accurate facts, grammar, spelling, and punctuation.
4. **Completeness:** Include all required information so the reader gets the full picture.
5. **Coherence:** Ideas must be logically connected and flow smoothly.
6. **Courtesy:** Maintain a polite and respectful tone throughout.
7. **Consideration:** Write with the reader's perspective and needs in mind.

Applying the 7 C's ensures professional, effective, and error-free written communication.